

Signal Architecture for Outbound

Parallel + Clay Build | For Peter Friis | 22 May 2026

This document rebuilds Forager's outbound signal architecture using only two tools, Parallel and Clay. It confirms which of the original ten signals carry over, which two do not, and the final list of ten custom signals to deploy across Forager's 300 to 400 strategic accounts. The TAM and enrichment are already in place. This is the intelligence layer that decides when to reach out, to which account, and why.

What Changes With a Parallel + Clay Build

Parallel's APIs cover everything Exa, TheirStack, and scheduled Google searches did, plus most of what OpenFunnel did. Neither Parallel nor Clay can see LinkedIn behavioral data, meaning who liked, commented on, or viewed a post, or which competitor rep is actively working an account. Two of the original ten signals therefore do not survive the swap:

- **Competitor AE activity.** Needs LinkedIn rep activity tracking, which is outside both tools.
- **Buyer engagement on competitor content.** Needs LinkedIn post engagement data, which is outside both tools.

Both gaps are replaced by two new signals that fit Forager's actual buyer, the data team, more directly.

How the Two Tools Split the Work

Parallel is the detection layer. Monitor API for continuous signal watching with webhook delivery, Search and Extract for verification, Task API to enrich and confirm details, and FindAll for net new account discovery.

Clay is the orchestration layer. Crunchbase, job postings, the 14 day rolling window, signal stacking and scoring, and CRM sync into HubSpot or Pipedrive. Parallel feeds Clay through HTTP and webhook, sitting exactly where OpenFunnel and Exa used to.

Tier 1 Signals: Live Buying Decision

Highest intent. A vendor decision is active or imminent. These accounts justify immediate, multi channel outreach the moment a second signal stacks.

#	Signal	What it tells us	Capture
1	AI product launch that consumes contact data	The account shipped an AI SDR, people search, sourcing, or contact lookup feature. The data vendor decision is live right now.	Parallel Monitor runs product launch queries per account. FindAll surfaces net new companies entering this category. Clay routes.
2	Hiring intent: data and enrichment infra roles	A role posted that will evaluate data vendors and build enrichment pipelines. New hires pick vendors in their first 90 days.	Clay job postings , plus Parallel Monitor watching careers pages and job boards for enrichment and data engineering language.
3	New data leader hired	A Head of Data, VP Data, or Director of Data Acquisition just started, arriving with a mandate to review the current stack.	Clay job change tracking flags the move. Parallel Task API enriches and confirms the mandate and scope.
4	Competitor pricing change or negative news (new)	A competitor such as PDL, Apollo, ZoomInfo, Cognism, Coresignal, or Lusha raised prices, had an outage, or took a public hit. A portfolio wide trigger that maps onto Forager's cost and refresh pitch.	Parallel Monitor on each competitor. One fire routes against every account known to use that vendor.
5	Funding round closed	The account just raised. Data infrastructure reliably lands in the top three post close budget items.	Clay Crunchbase , native, plus Parallel Monitor as a second source for rounds Crunchbase misses.

Tier 2 Signals: Pain Visible, Decision Not Yet Live

Pain is observable but a vendor decision is not yet active. These signals build the account score and warm the relationship before the buying window opens.

#	Signal	What it tells us	Capture
6	Competitor vendor relationship revealed in press.	A case study, partnership, or integration announcement exposes which competitor an account currently uses, giving a displacement angle and rough contract timing.	Parallel Monitor and Search, replacing Clay's scheduled Google with stronger recall. Theirstack - Check with Peter
7	Exec public statement on data or vendor pain	A CTO, CPO, or VP publicly raised contact data, mobile accuracy, or vendor pain on a blog, on X, on a podcast, or in press.	Parallel Monitor and Search across the open web. Narrower than the LinkedIn only version it replaces. Data not sufficient enough

#	Signal	What it tells us	Capture
8	Engineering blog on the data or enrichment stack	The account's engineering team published technical content describing their enrichment pipeline.	Parallel Monitor watching engineering blogs, plus the Extract API to pull full content for the SDR. Check with Parallel.ai
9	Podcast or conference talk on data infrastructure	An exec discussed their data infrastructure publicly, stating pain in their own words.	Parallel Search and Monitor against podcast and conference content. Check with Parallel.ai
10	Snowflake, warehouse, or marketplace adoption (new)	The account stood up Snowflake, adopted a warehouse, or is browsing data marketplaces. A delivery fit signal, since Forager ships via Snowflake Private Listing and S3 or GCS.	Parallel Monitor and Search, plus Clay tech stack enrichment. Theirstack